

Kaitlyn Rawlings

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Hydrological connectivity and surface-subsurface coupling · Headwater stream hydrology · Watershed restoration · Integration of GIS and spatial analysis in field-based research

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Environmental Studies	May 2023
<i>University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS</i>	GPA: 3.60
Geographic Information Science, Certificate	May 2024
<i>University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS</i>	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GIS Analyst	Jul 2025 – Present
<i>City of Lenexa — Public Works</i>	<i>Lenexa, KS</i>
- Develop spatial analysis workflows and automation tools in ArcGIS Pro, ModelBuilder, and Python/arcpy supporting stormwater hydrology, infrastructure planning, and asset management - Built citywide stormwater catchment delineation model using LiDAR-derived DEMs, D8 flow routing, and snap pour point analysis; automated pipe capacity joins with Python/arcpy - Developed ArcGIS Python toolbox for urban depression volume estimation - Maintain infrastructure asset databases in CentralSquare/Lucity; sole GIS staff member supporting citywide spatial data management and map production	
International Travel / Gap Year	Jun 2024 – May 2025
Solo traveled through 12 countries across 4 continents; developed cross-cultural communication, adaptability, and independent problem-solving.	
GIS Analyst II	Dec 2023 – May 2024
<i>Ervin Cable Construction LLC</i>	<i>Kansas City, MO</i>
- Utilized FME, ArcGIS Pro, and ArcGIS Online for telecom route planning, field engineering, and permitting across diverse markets - Built graphical workflows for data translation, format conversion, and automation	
Scientific Conference Manager	May – Aug 2023
<i>Gordon Research Conferences</i>	<i>Barcelona, Spain</i>
Managed on-site logistics and budget for weekly international scientific research conferences; supervised staff and interfaced daily with conference Chair and Vice Chair	
GIS Analyst	Jan – May 2022
<i>Topeka Utilities</i>	<i>Topeka, KS</i>
Created, edited, and updated infrastructure geometry and related attributes using ArcGIS Pro and ArcMap based on construction documents	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Student Consultant — Land Management Planning

Jan – May 2023

Quindaro Ruins Project Foundation / University of Kansas

Kansas City, KS

- Developed a land management and restoration plan for the historic Quindaro Ruins site as a capstone thesis project for the University of Kansas Environmental Studies program
- Combined GIS and ecological assessment to map invasive species distribution, evaluate habitat sensitivity, and design trail corridors balancing public access with ecological values

Research Assistant

Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

Kansas Biological Survey, Bever-Schultz Ecology Lab

Lawrence, KS

- Supported soil science research studying plant-microbial interactions under Dr. Jim Bever on the NSF Dimensions of Biodiversity project
- Conducted experiments on arbuscular mycorrhizal fungi (AMF) and their role in improving plant biodiversity restoration on post-agricultural prairie landscapes
- Maintained research plots, performed non-destructive vegetation sampling, identified and sorted plant species, extracted AMF spores from soil samples, and collected and entered experimental data

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENSES

FAA Remote Pilot Certificate (Part 107) — Drone Operations

Dec 2025 · Expires Dec 2027

Federal Aviation Administration · Credential ID: 5252950

Geographic Information Science Certificate

May 2024

University of Kansas

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GIS & Spatial Analysis: ArcGIS Pro, ArcGIS Online, FME, terrain analysis, site suitability analysis

Programming & Automation: Python, arcpy, ModelBuilder, automated workflows, GIS databases

Field & Ecological Methods: Vegetation sampling, plant identification, AMF spore extraction, experimental plot maintenance, restoration planning

Data Management: CentralSquare / Lucity, asset management, spatial databases, infrastructure data

UAV / Drone Operations: FAA Part 107 certified

ACTIVITIES & AFFILIATIONS

KU SEEDS Ecology Club · Omega Phi Alpha, National Community Service Sorority